



One on one questions to ask your manager: 15 to use

Last checked 5 October 2026. Fill in the [BRACKETS] with your own facts.

Your priorities

Your top priorities

What are the two or three things that matter most for me in the next [PERIOD]? If I have to choose, which comes first?

What good looks like

On [TASK OR PROJECT], what would a really good result look like to you? How will we both know?

The one thing to fix first

Is there one thing I could do differently that would make the biggest difference to you or the team?

Feedback

Ask for one thing to keep, one to change

What is one thing I should keep doing, and one thing I should change?

After a project

Looking at [PROJECT], what went well from your side, and what would you have liked to see differently?

When you got no feedback

I have not had much feedback since [DATE]. Could we agree a way for you to tell me how I am doing, maybe a few lines every [PERIOD]?

Growth and your next step

A skill you want

I would like to get better at [SKILL]. What could I take on, or who could I learn from, in the next [PERIOD]?

What the next role needs

What does someone need to show to move from [MY ROLE] to [NEXT ROLE]? Where am I against that now?

A training or course

I found [COURSE]. It would help me with [WORK TASK]. It costs [AMOUNT] and takes [TIME]. Is there a budget for it?

When something is going wrong

A blocker you cannot clear

I am blocked on [TASK] because of [REASON]. I have tried [WHAT YOU TRIED]. Could you help me with [ONE SPECIFIC THING]?

Too much work

I have [LIST OF TASKS]. I cannot do all of it by [DATE] and keep the quality up. Which one should I move or drop?

A problem with a colleague

I need a hand with something in how [NAME] and I work together. The facts are: [FACT 1], [FACT 2]. What I would like is [ONE CLEAR REQUEST].

Closing the meeting

Say it back

Here is what I took from that: [WHAT YOU HEARD]. Have I got that right?

Agree the next step

What should I do before we next meet, and what will you do? Can I send a short note to confirm?

Ask for a regular time

Could we meet for [TWENTY OR THIRTY] minutes every [TWO WEEKS]? I will bring the topics.

<https://proskillpacks.github.io/work/one-on-one-questions-to-ask-your-manager/>

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